MAH
Muslim Association of Hamilton

(905) 383-1526
www.hamiltonmosque.com

NOTICE
MID – TERM MEETING

MAH Board of Directors	
President: Javid Mirza	**Vice President:** Lubna Sartawi
Treasurer: Abdul Latif Barrih	**Assistant Treasurer:** N/A
Secretary: Yasmeen Mirza	**Assistant Secretary:** Anisa Malik
Director: Samir Hussein	**Director:** Adil Abu Lebdeh
Director: Nazlie Khan	**Director:** Nasreen Sahib
Director: Mifthioul Wahed	**Director:** Ala Mohamed
Officer of the Board: Ghulam Ali Mohatarem	Officer of the Board: Fadi Almobayed

This package contains information and documents pertaining to the Mid-term meeting.

1. Agenda for Midterm Meeting
2. Minutes from the Annual General Meeting 26/04/2025 (For Approval)

MAH Mid-term Meeting
November 30, 2025 – 12 to 3pm
Agenda

12.00 p.m. Recitation
12:05 p.m. Welcome
12:10 p.m. Approval of Minutes Annual General Meeting April 26, 2025 (For Approval)
12:15 p.m. President's Report
12:30 p.m. Finance Update
1:30 p.m. Dhuhr
1:50 p.m. Bylaw Amendment and Motion to approve
2:30 p.m. Questions
2:40 p. m. New Business
3:00 p.m. Dua and Adjournment

MAH AGM MINUTES

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Minutes of the Annual General Meeting (AGM)
Date: Friday, April 26, 2025
Location: Hamilton Mountain Mosque, 1545 Stone Church Road East
Meeting Commenced: 6:30 p.m.
Quorum Established: 57 members

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1. Tilawat and Welcome

- Tilawat recited by Br. Adil Abu Lebdeh.
- Welcome remarks provided.

2. Approval of Agenda

- **Amendment:** To allow Counselor Tom Jackson to speak first.
- **MOTION:** *To approve the agenda as amended to have Counselor Tom Jackson speak first.*
    - Moved by: Lubna Sartawi
    - Seconded by: Sameer Husain
    - **CARRIED**

3. Approval of Mid-Term Minutes (April 26, 2024)

- **MOTION:** *That the MAH membership approves the minutes of the mid-term meeting held on April 26, 2024.*
    - Moved by: Lubna Sartawi
    - Seconded by: Samir Hussein
    - **CARRIED**

4. President's Report

Presented by: **Br. Javid Mirza,** presented report as written in the Annual Report.

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- Highlights:
    - MAH is financially sound.
    - Capital projects underway: Parking lot expansion, Arbour Road property development.

- Future plans: Long-term care facility, seniors' housing, retail plaza, gym, and community centre.
- Cemetery lots purchased from the City of Hamilton.

5. Stone Church Road Development

- **Presented by:** Counselor Tom Jackson
- **Summary of Presentation:**
  - Emphasized the importance of collaboration between the City of Hamilton and MAH.
  - Past collaborations included facilitating a free-standing highway sign for revenue and supporting parking lot acquisitions.
  - **Arbour Road and Stone Church Developments:**
    - Installation of a traffic signal at Arbour Road.
    - Construction of a multi-use pathway for cyclists on the south side and sidewalk sections.
    - Budget limitations for the north side (mosque side) sidewalks noted.
    - Timeline: Construction to start within 30 days, completion by September 2025.
  - Introduced **Baker Syed** to work directly with MAH.
  - Acknowledged Friday prayer parking challenges and proposed further discussions.
  - $80 million Rymal to Dartnall project approved.
  - Townhall meeting to be scheduled for further community engagement.

Q&A: Members asked questions about sidewalk development and parking, answered to satisfaction.

6. Secretary's Report

Presented by: **Yasmeen Mirza-** Presented report as written in the Annual Report.

- Highlights:
  - Appointment of Sheikh Reda Bedeir as new Imam.

- Appointment of Br. Fadi Almobayed as Board Officer (IT Specialist).

- **MOTION:** *That the Secretary's Report be accepted as presented.*
  - Moved by: Javid Mirza
  - Seconded by: Ala Mohammed
  - **CARRIED**

7. Islamic School of Hamilton Report

- Presented by: **Br. Yousef Kfaween**
- Highlights:
  - Activities included Quran Competition, Tarbiyah Class, Soccer Tournament, Ramadan Iftars, and Mental Health Awareness initiatives.

Q&A: All questions answered satisfactorily.

8. Umar Mosque Report

- Presented by: **Br. Javid Mian**
- Highlights:
  - Programs included children's classes, daily iftars, Tajweed programs, and mosque expansion efforts.

9. Approval of Majlis El Shura

- Explanation by: **Br. Javid Mirza**
- Four members stepped down.
- New appointments proposed:
- **MOTION:** *That the MAH membership approves the appointment of Br. Raid Javid, Br. Abdul Haq (Babo Bhai), Br. Emad Al Amad, and Br. Noridian to the Majlis El Shura for a two-year term commencing May 1, 2025.*
  - Moved by: Javid Mirza
  - Seconded by: Abdul Latif
  - **CARRIED**

10. Announcement of Candidates for MAH Elections

- Presented by: **Br. Abdul Kareem Mustafa**
- Positions:

  - **President:** Javid Mirza (Acclaimed)
  - **Secretary:** Yasmeen Mirza (Acclaimed)
  - **Assistant Treasurer:** Muhammad Waleed (Acclaimed)
  - **Board of Directors:** 4 candidates for 3 positions.
- **Voting Date:** Sunday, April 26, 2025, from Zuhr to Maghrib.
- **Candidate Presentation:** Br. Marouane Tebib shared his background and commitment.

11. Financial Report

- Presented by: **Br. Zeshan Arshad**
- Highlights:
  - Surplus maintained.
  - Report unaudited; audited statements to follow in a special meeting.
- **MOTION 1:** *That the MAH membership accepts the unaudited financial statements for the fiscal year ending 2025 as presented.*
  - Moved by: Ajaz Butt
  - Seconded by: Zak Ahmed
  - **CARRIED**
- **MOTION 2:** *That the MAH membership approves the appointment of CBM Chartered Accountants for the fiscal year 2025–2026.*
  - Moved by: Javid Mirza
  - Seconded by: Mifthioul Wahed
  - **CARRIED**

12. New Business

- No formal new business.
- **Discussion:**
  - High School Project: Br. Javid Mirza updated members on MAH's collaboration with a professional organization building a high school in Hamilton.

13. Dua and Adjournment

- Meeting adjourned at **8:15 p.m.** with dua led by **Br. Adil Abu Lebdeh**.

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MUSLIM ASSOCIATION OF HAMILTON ("MAH")

NOTICE TO MEMBERS – PROPOSED BYLAW AMENDMENTS

To be voted on at the Mid-Term General Meeting
Date: November 30, 2025
Location: Hamilton Mountain Mosque
Distribution Date: November 20, 2025
(10 days prior, as required under Bylaw 35)

Dear Members of the Muslim Association of Hamilton,

Assalamu Alaikum wa Rahmatullahi wa Barakatuh,

In accordance with section 35 of the MAH Bylaws, the Board of Directors (the "Board") is circulating the following proposed amendments to the MAH Bylaws. These amendments are limited to updating and modernizing:

- Section 26 – Membership
- Section 27 – Dues

No other sections of the MAH Bylaws are being changed at this time.

These updates:

- Bring MAH into compliance with Ontario *Not-for-Profit Corporations Act*, 2010 ("ONCA")
- Ensure a more organized and fair membership system
- Strengthening eligibility requirements and community integrity
- Clarify petition/requisition rules for Special Members' Meetings
- Update dues and align them with MAH's financial needs
- Recognize MAH's multi-mosque structure (Omar Mosque, Ancaster Mosque)

These amendments will be presented to the members for voting at the November 30, 2025, Mid-Term General Meeting.

May Allah guide us to what is best for our community.

MAH Board of Directors

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SUMMARY OF PROPOSED AMENDMENTS

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Below is a summary of the proposed amendments to the MAH Bylaws:

1. Replace Section 26 (Membership) with a new, comprehensive Membership section

- Strengthens eligibility requirements
- Includes character, volunteer, and commitment expectations
- Requires proposer and seconder for new applicants (2-year membership requirement)
- Adds Board authority to waive conditions
- Adds a formal petition/requisition requirement:
    - Must be signed by Members representing ten percent (**10%)** of total voting rights, in alignment with ONCA
    - Must include full name, address, phone, email, signature, and date
    - Must clearly state purpose and business
    - Invalid petitions will not trigger a meeting
- Introduces LMOCs (Local Mosque Operational Committees) for MAH's multi-location structure
- Clarifies rights and restrictions of Membership

2. Replace Section 27 (Dues) entirely

- Annual membership fee is **$100 per Member**
- Spouse and children 16+ must pay $100 each to be Members

- Donations over $100 can replace dues
- Donations of $1,000+ cover the whole family provided the membership dues requirements are met
- Membership lasts from January 1 to December 31 of the year of payment
- To vote, a Member must be:
    - In good standing
    - A Member for **fifty (50) days** prior to any meeting of members
- Clarifies good standing requirements
- Dues may be deducted from donations if names are indicated

3. Remove the last line in Section 28 (Annual and Other Meetings of Members), as follows:

Additional general meeting can be called if the board receives a petition by fifty (50) members of the Association.

This is due to the new petition/requisition requirement in section 26.

FULL TEXT OF PROPOSED AMENDMENTS

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1. FULL REPLACEMENT OF SECTION 26 – MEMBERSHIP

SECTION 26 – MEMBERSHIP (NEW)

26(a)
Voting Membership in the Association is open to individuals who meet the following conditions:

1. Any Muslims aged sixteen (16) years or older (consent by legal guardian, attorney for property, or caregiver required for applicants under 18);
2. Are Canadian citizens, permanent residents, or legal residents;
3. Support and agree to further the purposes and objectives of the Association;
4. Agree to abide by the By-Laws and all policies and procedures of the Association;
5. Demonstrate a sincere interest in serving the Muslim community through time, effort, and/or financial support;
6. Are trustworthy, committed, and loyal to the Association and abide by its decisions;
7. Have their membership application proposed by one Member and seconded by another, both of whom must have been Members in good standing for at least two (2) consecutive

years immediately prior to submission of the membership application;
  - This requirement applies only to first-time applicants.
8. Demonstrate commitment through volunteer service and/or financial contributions to the Association.

26(b) Board Discretion
The Board may waive or shorten requirements in subsection (a) after considering:

1. Islamic character;
2. Special capabilities;
3. Service record with Islamic organizations.

26(c) Admission of Members
Applications for admission to membership must follow the Board-approved form and process. The Board or a delegated committee may admit an applicant by resolution of the Board or in such other manner as may be determined by the Board.
No reasons need be provided for acceptance or rejection of an application for membership.

26(d) Member Expectations
Members must:

1. Conduct themselves in a manner that does not harm the Association;
2. Endeavour to fulfill any duty they undertake.

26(e) Right to Requisition a Special Members' Meeting (NEW)

A valid requisition for a special meeting of members requires:

1. Signatures representing at least ten per cent **(10%) of the votes that may be cast at a meeting of members (ONCA S60(1))**
2. Each signatory must provide:
   - Full legal name
   - Residential address
   - Email address
   - Phone number
   - Signature
   - Date
3. The requisition must state the **purpose** and the **business** for the requested meeting.

4. The requisition must be sent to each director and to the registered office of the Association.
5. Petitions not meeting all requirements are **invalid** and do not obligate the Board to call a special meeting of members.
6. The Board must call a Special Members' Meeting within **21 days** of receiving a valid requisition, subject to any exception in ONCA.

26(f) Membership Classes – Regular & Life Members

Subject to the articles, membership in the Corporation shall consist of two (2) classes of members, namely, Regular Members and Life Members.

Regular Members: 1-, year term, renewable; voting rights available if eligibility conditions met.

Life Members: Existing Life Members remain; no new Life Members will be created.

Subject to the Act and the articles, each Regular Member and Life Member is entitled to receive notice of, attend, and vote at all meetings of members, and each Regular Member and Life Member shall be entitled to one (1) vote at such meetings.

26(g) Multi-Mosque Structure – LMOCs (NEW)

The Board may establish Local Mosque Operational Committees (LMOCs) for:

- Omar Mosque (East Hamilton)
- Ancaster Mosque
- Future MAH-operated mosques/ Facilities

LMOCs:

1. Are appointed and overseen by the Board;

2. Help with day-to-day operations;
3. Are members of the Association;
4. Must report regularly to the Board;
5. May be dissolved by the Board.

26(h) Rights & Restrictions

Members have rights and responsibilities defined in these By-Laws and under ONCA.

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2. FULL REPLACEMENT OF SECTION 27 – DUES

SECTION 27 – DUES (NEW)

27(a) Membership Term

Membership is valid for the calendar year in which the membership dues or qualifying donations are received, beginning on January 1 and ending on December 31 of that same year.

27(b) Annual Membership Fee

$100 per Member.

27(c) Family Members

Spouses and children 16+ who wish to be Members must each pay $100 and complete an annual membership application.

27(d) Donations Over $100

Donations over $100 replace annual dues for that Member (application form still required).

27(e) Family Donation Rule

Donations of **$1,000+** replace annual dues if the donation fully covers for:

- Member
- Spouse
- Children 16+
  (Each must submit a membership form.)

27(f) Automatic Deductions from Donations

Dues can be applied from donations if the donor indicates the individual's receiving membership.

27(g) Good Standing Requirement

Membership rights may only be exercised if dues/donation are submitted.

27(h) Voting Eligibility (NEW)

To vote at any Annual Meeting or Special Members' Meeting, a Member must:

1. Be in good standing; and
2. Have been a Member for **fifty (50) days** immediately before the meeting.

SECTION 28 – ANNUAL AND OTHER MEETINGS OF MEMBERS

Remove the last line:

Additional general meeting can be called if the board receives a petition by fifty (50) members of the Association.

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VOTING ITEMS FOR NOVEMBER 30, 2025

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Members will vote on the following motions:

Motion 1:

To replace Section 26 – Membership with the proposed new Section 26.

Motion 2:

To replace Section 27 – Dues with the proposed new Section 27.

Motion 3:

To delete the last line in Section 28.

Motion 4:

To adopt the new multi-mosque membership structure through LMOCs.